



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

imaṃ tārksya+upama+javaṃ* | turaṃ+gam anugacchatā |
darśitā saumya mad+bhaktir* | vikramaś* ca*ayam ātmanaḥ | | 6.5 |*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 6, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse from the Buddhacarita reveals a profound moment of connection between Siddhartha and his loyal horse, Kanthaka, as Siddhartha prepares to renounce his royal life. The verse speaks of Kanthaka's incredible speed and devotion, comparing his swiftness to that of Garuda, the mythical bird known for its powerful flight. It acknowledges the horse's faithfulness in accompanying Siddhartha and recognizes the inherent strength and resolve demonstrated by Siddhartha himself in undertaking such a significant departure. The verse highlights the bond of loyalty and the courage needed for spiritual transformation.

The essence of this passage lies not just in the physical act of leaving, but in the symbolic representation of detaching from worldly attachments. Kanthaka's unwavering loyalty mirrors the kind of dedication you must cultivate on your own spiritual journey. Like Kanthaka, you need steadfast commitment to your path, even when faced with obstacles. Siddhartha's "vikrama," or strength, is not merely physical; it's the inner fortitude required to confront your own illusions and attachments. This leaving behind of everything familiar is a precursor to awakening.

In modern life, we are constantly bombarded with distractions and temptations that pull us away from our inner selves. This verse reminds you to cultivate inner strength and unwavering devotion to your own spiritual path, whatever that may be. It asks you to examine your own "Kanthaka" – the loyal aspects of yourself that support your growth – and your own "vikrama" – the courage you possess to break free from limiting patterns and embrace a more authentic existence. Consider what you might need to leave behind in order to pursue a deeper sense of purpose and peace. Just as Siddhartha recognized Kanthaka's role, recognize and appreciate the forces that support your journey.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What "Kanthaka" qualities within yourself can you nurture today to support your journey towards inner peace, and what "royal life" attachments might you need to gently release to move forward?